

Heat plan: On Indian cities and heat-related preparedness

India must develop a **comprehensive** heat strategy ahead of COP30

Summer has arrived early in several parts of India. In the last week of February, heatwaves were officially reported in Goa and Maharashtra. **States** such as Odisha, Telangana, and Maharashtra **have** already recorded temperatures exceeding 40°C. **Throughout** most of February, 31 States and Union Territories experienced night temperatures at least 1°C above normal, with 22 States and Union Territories reporting night temperatures that were 3°C to 5°C above normal. **Given** that February is classified as 'winter' by the India Meteorological Department, these are **signposts** that **point toward** new climate normals. Scientists have long warned that rising global **temperatures** — both on land and sea — **will result in** more intense and frequent heatwaves. This **underscores** the need for countries and States to prepare for heat events just as they do for earthquakes or floods. However, a recent **study** by the Sustainable Futures Collaborative, which **examined** heat-related preparedness in nine Indian cities, **found** that none had long-term plans **in place**. Most responses are limited to short-term emergency measures such as providing drinking water, adjusting work hours, and boosting hospital capacity during heatwaves. Crucial long-term **interventions** such as ensuring access to household or **occupational** cooling for **vulnerable** populations, insuring workers against lost income on extremely hot days, improving fire management, and upgrading electricity **grids** for reliability **are** missing. Few cities have even begun planning for expanded local weather monitoring, **mapping urban heat islands**, or training those responsible for implementing heat plans. Other **strategies**, which include increasing green cover, creating open spaces to reduce heat, and **deploying** rooftop solar for active cooling, **are** often **carried out** without targeting the populations that are most at risk.

While global efforts to **combat** climate change largely focus on cutting **greenhouse gas emissions**, the limited progress on that **front** is shifting attention to **adaptation** — particularly in managing responses to heat. Affordable cooling devices are frequently recommended, but they raise concerns about increased use of **ozone-depleting refrigerants**. Experts now **advocate** having **sustainable** buildings, green infrastructure, and **passive** cooling solutions, although these too can impact land prices and urban planning. India must develop a comprehensive national heat strategy and **embed** it within its National Adaptation Plan ahead of the 30th UN Climate Change Conference (COP30) in Brazil in November.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Preparedness** (noun) – Readiness, Alertness, Preparedness, Planning, Forethought तैयारी
2. **Comprehensive** (adjective) – Thorough, Complete, Exhaustive, Extensive, Inclusive व्यापक
3. **Throughout** (preposition) – Across, All over, During, All through, Everywhere पूरे समय
4. **Given** (preposition) – Considering, Taking into account, In view of, Bearing in mind, Due to देखते हुए
5. **Signpost** (noun) – Indicator, Signal, Marker, Guidepost, Clue संकेत
6. **Point toward** (phrasal verb) – Indicate, Suggest, Hint, Signal, Direct इशारा करना
7. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – Lead to, Cause, Bring about, Trigger, Produce परिणाम होना
8. **Underscore** (verb) – Emphasize, Highlight, Stress, Accentuate, Reinforce जोर देना
9. **Examine** (verb) – Analyze, Inspect, Study, Assess, Evaluate जांच करना
10. **In place** (phrase) – Established, Operational, Functional, Active, Set up लागू
11. **Intervention** (noun) – Action, Measure, Step, Involvement, Interference हस्तक्षेप
12. **Occupational** (adjective) – Work-related, Professional, Job-related, Employment-related, Vocational व्यावसायिक
13. **Vulnerable** (adjective) – At risk, Exposed, Susceptible, Defenseless, Weak कमजोर
14. **Grid** (noun) – Network, System, Framework, Infrastructure, Matrix ग्रिड
15. **Map** (verb) – Chart, Plot, Outline, Plan, Diagram मानचित्र बनाना
16. **Urban heat island** (noun) – A metropolitan area significantly warmer than its surroundings due to human activities शहरी ताप द्वीप
17. **Deploy** (verb) – Utilize, Employ, Use, Implement, Position उपयोग करना
18. **Carry out** (phrasal verb) – Execute, Implement, Perform, Conduct, Accomplish पूरा करना
19. **Combat** (verb) – Fight, Tackle, Counter, Resist, Oppose मुकाबला करना
20. **Greenhouse gas emission** (noun) – Release of gases like CO₂ that trap heat in the atmosphere ग्रीनहाउस गैस उत्सर्जन
21. **Front** (noun) – Area, Field, Domain, Sphere, Sector मोर्चा

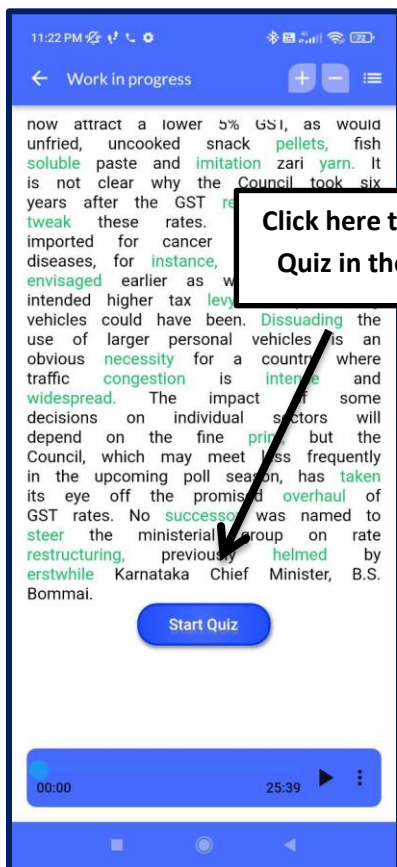
22. **Adaptation** (noun) – Adjustment, Modification, Change, Accommodation, Evolution अनुकूलन
23. **Ozone-depleting** (adjective) – Harmful to the ozone layer, Damaging, Destructive, Harmful, Toxic ओजोन क्षयकारी
24. **Refrigerant** (noun) – a substance used for refrigeration.
25. **Advocate** (verb) – Support, Promote, Champion, Endorse, Recommend समर्थन करना
26. **Sustainable** (adjective) – Eco-friendly, Renewable, Long-lasting, Environmentally friendly, Viable टिकाऊ
27. **Passive** (adjective) – Inactive, Non-active, Uninvolved, Submissive, Receptive निष्क्रिय
28. **Embed** (verb) – Integrate, Incorporate, Insert, Implant, Fix समाहित करना

@mocks_wallah

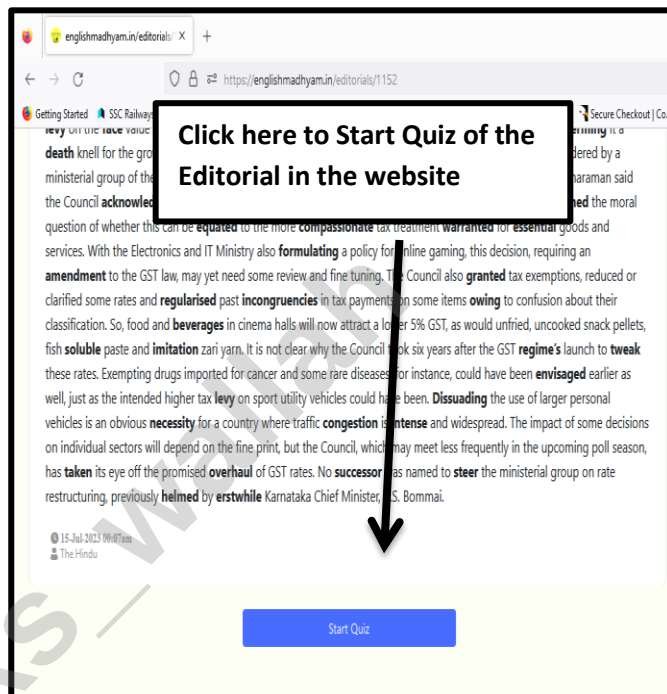
Summary of the Editorial

1. Early summer and heatwaves in India: Several parts of India, including Goa, Maharashtra, Odisha, and Telangana, experienced heatwaves and temperatures exceeding 40°C as early as February, signaling new climate normals.
2. Rising temperatures: Scientists warn that increasing global temperatures will lead to more intense and frequent heatwaves, necessitating preparedness similar to that for natural disasters like earthquakes or floods.
3. Lack of long-term heat preparedness: A study by the Sustainable Futures Collaborative revealed that none of the nine Indian cities examined had long-term heat-related preparedness plans.
4. Short-term measures: Current responses are limited to emergency actions such as providing drinking water, adjusting work hours, and increasing hospital capacity during heatwaves.
5. Missing long-term interventions: Critical measures like access to cooling for vulnerable populations, income insurance for workers on extremely hot days, fire management, and electricity grid upgrades are largely absent.
6. Limited urban planning: Few cities have started planning for expanded weather monitoring, urban heat island mapping, or training for heat plan implementation.
7. Inadequate targeted strategies: Efforts like increasing green cover, creating open spaces, and deploying rooftop solar for cooling often fail to focus on the most at-risk populations.
8. Global focus on adaptation: With limited progress in reducing greenhouse gas emissions, global efforts are shifting toward adaptation strategies, particularly for heat management.
9. Concerns over cooling devices: While affordable cooling devices are recommended, they raise issues related to ozone-depleting refrigerants.
10. Sustainable solutions: Experts advocate for sustainable buildings, green infrastructure, and passive cooling solutions, though these may impact land prices and urban planning.
11. Need for a national heat strategy: India must develop a comprehensive national heat strategy to address the growing challenges posed by rising temperatures.
12. Integration with National Adaptation Plan: The heat strategy should be embedded within India's National Adaptation Plan to ensure a coordinated approach.
13. COP30 relevance: The strategy should be developed ahead of the 30th UN Climate Change Conference (COP30) in Brazil in November 2025.
14. Focus on vulnerable populations: Long-term plans must prioritize the needs of vulnerable groups, including access to cooling and income protection.
15. Holistic approach: A combination of sustainable urban planning, green infrastructure, and targeted interventions is essential to mitigate the impacts of heatwaves and climate change.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



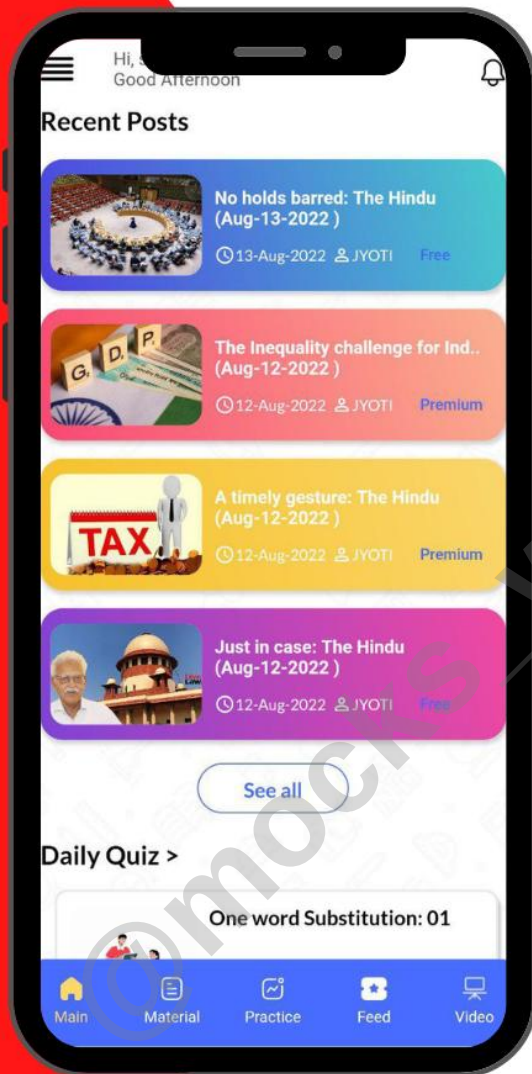
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